

How to Spot a Freight Scam & Stop It.

A simple handbook, in plain English, for the people who book loads, vet carriers, handle papers and send payments. Real cases. Real numbers. Clear steps.



\$725M stolen in 2025 +60% losses vs 2024 \$2.8B lost to email scams
Sources: Verisk CargoNet · FBI IC3

START HERE · 1 MINUTE

What this book is

This handbook teaches one skill: how to tell a **real** partner from a **pretender**. That is what almost every freight scam comes down to.

A scam, in one line: A stranger pretends to be someone you trust — a trucker, a broker, your own boss — so you hand over **money** or **cargo** before you notice. Your job is to catch the pretender *before* you click "send."

We will go in order. First the **Big Three** scams (the ones that steal the most). Then **every other type**, explained in one breath each. Then a map of **where** the chain breaks, the **numbers** that prove this is real, and finally your **daily shield** — a checklist you can keep on your desk.

Every scam card ends with a green **"Stop it"** strip. If you only remember the green parts, you will already be ahead of most teams.

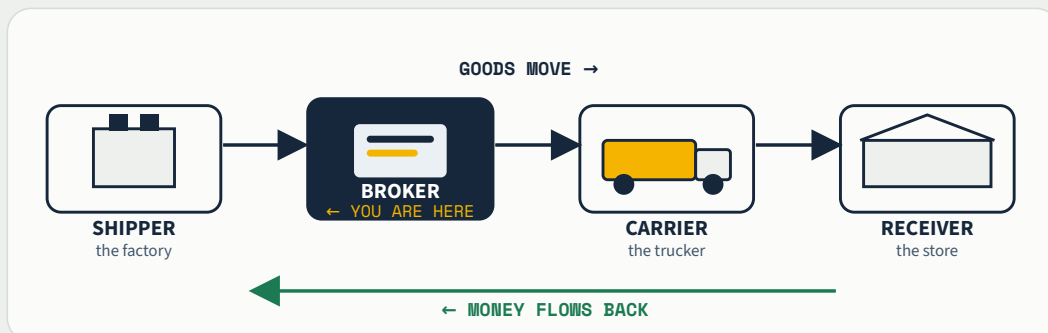
CHAPTER 1

Why scammers love the BPO desk

A freight BPO team is the back office for a shipping company — often working from another country. You are the hands that keep loads moving.

What "BPO" means here: Business Process Outsourcing. In freight, that's your team **finding trucks, booking loads, tracking shipments, handling paperwork, and paying carriers** on behalf of a broker. You don't drive the truck — you make the deal happen.

Look at the journey of one load. The factory (shipper) wants goods moved. A broker finds a truck. A carrier sends a driver. The store (receiver) gets the goods. Then money flows back down the line. **You help run the broker's part** — the middle.



► You sit in the middle, holding three things scammers want: the **money**, the **logins**, and the power to say "**yes, release the load.**"

That's the whole reason you are a target. The driver only has one truck. The shipper only has its own goods. But **you** touch many loads, many payments, and the company's email and systems — every single day. Break one tired, rushed agent for ten minutes, and a scammer can redirect a whole truckload.

CHAPTER 2 • THE BIG THREE

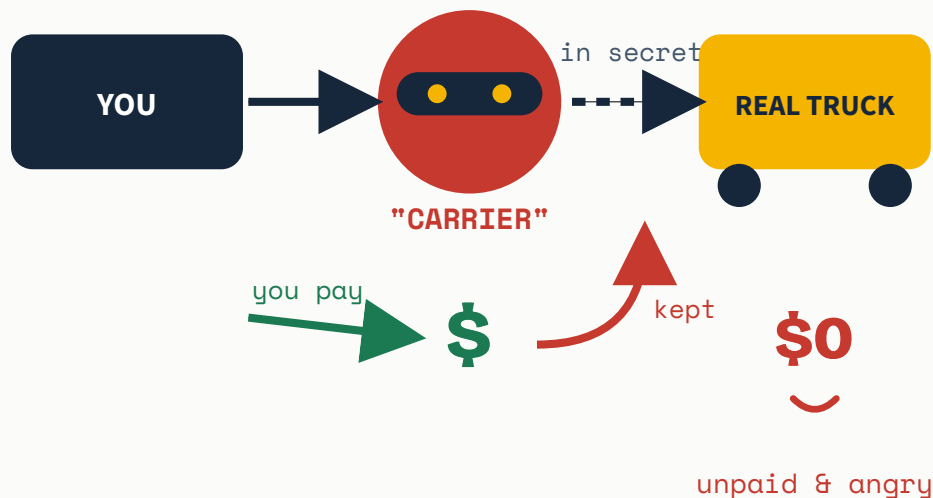
The three scams that steal the most

Learn these three first. They cause most of the loss, and the other scams are usually just pieces of these.

NO. 1

Double Brokering

a.k.a. "secretly passing the load to a stranger"



- Left to right: you hire a "carrier," who secretly passes your load to a **real trucker**, keeps **your** payment, and leaves the real trucker unpaid.

HOW IT WORKS

- 1 A "carrier" books your load and promises to haul it.
- 2 Instead of driving it, they **secretly hand it to a different, real trucker** at a lower price.
- 3 You pay the booked "carrier." They keep the money and **vanish**.
- 4 The real trucker delivered the goods but is **never paid** — and now wants *your* company to pay again.

Hits: real truckers, your company, shippers

Trend: ↑ ~400% more complaints

STOP IT

- ✓ **Forbid re-brokering in writing** in your rate confirmation.
- ✓ Confirm the truck that *actually* shows up matches the carrier you booked.
- ✓ Get the **driver's name, the truck and trailer number, and a pickup photo**.
- ✓ If the carrier "subcontracts," or the driver doesn't match the paperwork — **freeze the payment and verify** before anyone gets paid.

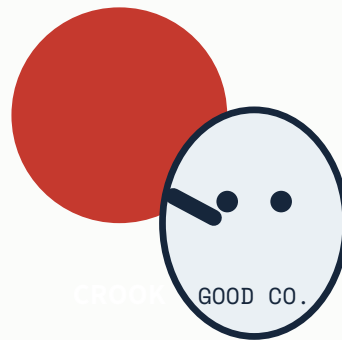
A man running the scheme from Tijuana, Mexico, stole the identity of a real California trucking company, agreed to haul loads under that stolen name, then re-brokered the same loads to other truckers. He collected the delivery payments and never paid the truckers who actually moved the freight. He was arrested abroad, extradited to the United States, pleaded guilty, and agreed to pay restitution.

Restitution owed to victims: at least \$239,904. — U.S. DOJ
(via Overdrive)

NO. 2

Identity Theft & Impersonation

a.k.a. "wearing a real company as a mask" (this is most "strategic theft")



"I am Good Co." → grabs the load → gone

- ▶ A crook holds up a real carrier's name and clean record **like a mask**, books your load under it, then steals the freight. The real company never knew.

HOW IT WORKS

- 1 A crook copies a **real, trusted carrier's** name, MC/DOT number, and even its email look.
- 2 Wearing that "mask," they book a high-value load from you. You see a clean safety record and say yes.
- 3 The cargo is handed to a driver who **drives it somewhere else and steals it** for resale.
- 4 The real company never knew. You only find out when loads go missing under their name.

Hits: shippers, brokers, the real carrier's name

Trend: ↑ from under 5% to roughly a third of cargo theft

STOP IT

- ✓ **Don't trust a name or number alone.**
- ✓ Call the carrier back on a number *you* looked up in official records — **never the number in the email.**
- ✓ Watch for fresh changes to contact info or insurance, brand-new authority, and mailbox-only addresses.
- ✓ A familiar logo is not proof — **verify the human on the other end.**

Investigators and a cargo-theft analytics firm helped a New York prosecutor charge an organized ring that impersonated legitimate carriers across several states to misdirect and steal shipments. These are not lone amateurs — they are **organized groups** running impersonation like a business, which is exactly why the average theft is now worth so much.

Average value of one theft in 2025: \$273,990 — Verisk
CargoNet

NO. 3

Business Email Compromise (BEC) & Phishing

a.k.a. "the fake – or hacked – email that redirects your money"



good-co.**com** = real
good-co.**co** = the trap (one letter off!)

- One letter is the trap: **good-co.com** is real; **good-co.co** is the crook. The look-alike email sends your payment to their bank.

HOW IT WORKS

- 1 You get an email that looks normal — from a "carrier," "vendor," or even your "boss."
- 2 It says: **banking details changed, please pay the new account** — and it sounds urgent.
- 3 The address is a tiny bit wrong (.co not .com), or a real account was hacked so the email is genuinely from them.
- 4 You pay. The money lands in the crook's account and is moved away within minutes.

Hits: your payments team, anyone who wires money

Trend: ↑ harder to spot — real accounts get hacked now

STOP IT

- ✓ **Never change bank details from an email alone.**
- ✓ Call the known contact on a saved number and confirm out loud.
- ✓ Read the sender's full address **letter by letter**.
- ✓ Turn on **two-step login (MFA)** for email.
- ✓ Treat any "urgent + secret + new account" message as a red flag until a second person confirms.
- ✓ When money is involved, **slow down on purpose**.

The FBI's Internet Crime Complaint Center logged 21,442 business-email-compromise complaints in a single year, second only to investment fraud for total dollars lost. Logistics and shipping are squarely in the crosshairs because the industry moves money fast and trusts familiar email threads about invoices and loads.

BEC losses in 2024: about \$2.8 billion (≈\$8.5B across 2022-2024) – FBI IC3

CHAPTER 3 · THE FULL DECK

Every other scam, one breath each

Most of these are cousins of the Big Three. For each one: what it is, the tell (the warning sign), and how to stop it.

Mask scams — fake identities

Crooks pretend to be a company that exists, or invent one that looks real.



Phantom & "chameleon" carriers

A fake trucking company that doesn't really operate — or a banned one that reopens under a brand-new name to hide its bad past.

- 🚩 Brand-new authority, no real history, address is a mailbox, story keeps changing.
- ✓ **Stop:** check age of authority + a real, verifiable office; be extra careful with "new" carriers.



Fictitious (fake) pickup

A driver shows up with the right-looking paperwork, takes the real load, and is never seen again.

- 🚩 Driver/truck don't match the booking; rushed or odd pickup; can't verify the dispatcher.
- ✓ **Stop:** verify the driver + truck against your booking and photograph everything at pickup.



Forged paperwork

Fake or edited Bills of Lading, delivery receipts (PODs), or rate confirmations made to look official.

- 🚩 Logos slightly off, copy-pasted signatures, numbers that don't match your system.
- ✓ **Stop:** match every document to your own records; confirm details with the known source, not the document.



Stolen broker identity

Crooks pretend to be a well-known *broker* (not just a carrier) to book trucks and run double-brokering at scale.

- 🚩 "Broker" uses free email, off-brand domains, pressure to skip your normal checks.
- ✓ **Stop:** confirm the broker through official records and a known number before you commit a truck.



FMCSA record tampering

Crooks quietly change a real carrier's phone, email, or insurance in the official FMCSA database, so your verification calls and payments reach *them* — not the real company.

- 🚩 Contact details on file changed recently; the number you call "confirms" everything a little too smoothly.
- ✓ **Stop:** don't trust one record — cross-check against an older source, watch for recent changes, and confirm on a second known channel.

Money scams — getting paid for nothing

These aim straight at the cash, not always the cargo.



Fuel-advance scam

A "carrier" books a load only to get the upfront fuel money, then disappears without ever hauling it.

- 🚩 New carrier pushes hard for a fuel advance before pickup.
- ✓ **Stop:** limit or delay advances for unproven carriers; verify the truck is really moving first.



Non-payment (by a broker)

A weak or dishonest broker takes the shipper's money but never pays the carrier who hauled the load.

- 🚩 Excuses, delays, "check is coming," broker hard to reach after delivery.
- ✓ **Stop:** check the broker's bond and payment reputation before hauling; keep written agreements.



Proof-of-delivery (POD) fraud

A fake "delivered" receipt is used to claim payment for goods that were stolen or never delivered.

- 🚩 POD arrives oddly fast, signatures look generic, receiver can't confirm.
- ✓ **Stop:** confirm delivery directly with the receiver before releasing final payment.



Surprise extra charges

A "mover" or carrier holds goods hostage and demands extra fees far above the agreed price.

- 🚩 Price jumps after pickup; threats to keep the cargo until you pay more.
- ✓ **Stop:** lock prices in a signed agreement; refuse pay-or-we-keep-it demands and document them.

Computer scams — breaking into your systems

Here the target is your *login*. With it, a crook becomes you.



Account takeover

A crook gets into a real email or load-board account and operates it as if they were the real owner.

- ▀ Strange logins, changed contact info, messages that feel "off" from a known account.
- ✓ **Stop:** turn on two-step login (MFA), never reuse passwords, report odd account behaviour fast.



Load-board credential hack

Stolen load-board logins let crooks post thousands of fake loads to lure and trap real carriers.

- ▀ Too-good rates, mass postings, contact details that don't match the real company.
- ✓ **Stop:** secure board logins, verify any load that looks unusually good, don't download offered "forms."



Phishing, smishing & quishing

Scam messages by email, text, or fake QR code that trick you into typing a password or opening malware — disguised as a "dispute," "new form," or "account alert."

- ▀ Pressure to act now, odd links or QR codes, login pages that look slightly wrong.
- ✓ **Stop:** don't click links or scan QR codes in surprise messages; type the website yourself or use a saved bookmark.



Offshore / shared-access leak

Risk when too many people (or outside helpers) share one login into the broker's internal systems.

- ▀ Shared passwords, no record of who did what, access that nobody removed.
- ✓ **Stop:** give each person their own login, remove access when roles change, keep an activity trail.

People scams — tricking the human

The newest and oldest trick: skip the computers, fool the person.



Social engineering

A smooth talker uses urgency, authority, or friendliness to push you past your normal checks.

- ▀ "Do it now," "keep this quiet," "your boss approved it" — pressure instead of proof.
- ✓ **Stop:** pressure is the red flag. Pause, verify on a known channel, and it's always okay to say "let me confirm."



AI-powered fraud (emerging)

Crooks now use AI to write flawless scam emails and to fake a familiar voice — or even video — to "prove" they are your boss or a known carrier.

- ▀ A trusted voice or a polished email suddenly asking for money or a load change; pressure to act now.
- ✓ **Stop:** a voice or a perfect email is not proof anymore. Confirm big requests with a code word or a second known channel.

Road & cargo scams — stealing the freight itself

Here the target is the physical load — taken on the road, at the dock, or by someone on the inside.



Cargo hostage / extortion

Once a crook controls your load, they refuse to deliver and demand a ransom to reveal where the truck and goods are.

- ▀ The load goes silent after pickup, then a sudden demand for extra money to release it.
- ✓ **Stop:** vet carriers up front, track the load, and never pay a ransom alone — escalate, document, and involve security and law enforcement.



Fake inspection / fake tow

Someone poses as a DOT inspector, police officer, or tow service and demands instant payment for a made-up fine or towing bill.

- ▀ On-the-spot cash demand, pressure to pay now, paperwork or ID that can't be verified.
- ✓ **Stop:** real fines and tows can be verified — slow down, confirm with the official agency, and never pay strangers on the spot.



"Trojan driver" (insider)

A gang member gets hired as a real driver, works normally for a while, then leaves a loaded truck somewhere for accomplices to steal.

- ▀ A new driver targets high-value loads, makes odd route choices, or leaves a truck in a strange spot.
- ✓ **Stop:** screen and background-check drivers, watch high-value loads closely, and use tracking and check-in rules.



Pilferage / document swap

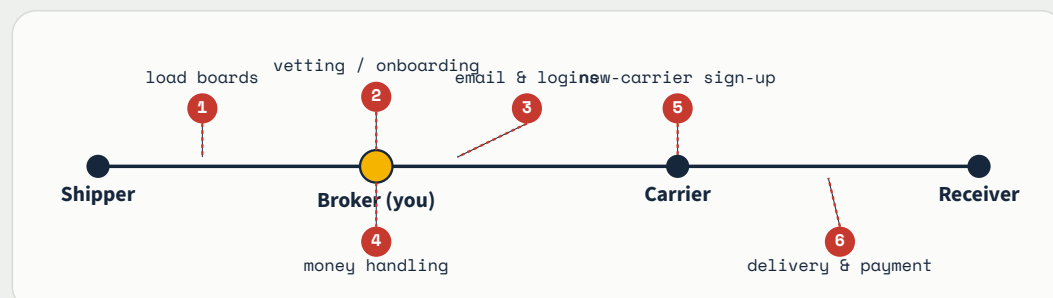
Small amounts are stolen from a shipment and the paperwork is quietly altered to hide that anything is missing.

- ▀ Counts don't match the paperwork, edited or re-printed documents, seals that look tampered with.
- ✓ **Stop:** count and seal at pickup and delivery, match every figure to your own records, and flag any altered document.

CHAPTER 4 • THE WEAK SEAMS

Where the chain breaks

Scammers don't attack everywhere. They look for the loose stitch. Here is the same chain from Chapter 1 — now with the weak points marked in red.



► The whole industry guards the front door — booking the load. So crooks now sneak in **downstream**: after the load is booked, at delivery and payment.

- 1 Load boards**
Where loads and trucks meet — and where fake loads and stolen logins flood in.
- 2 Vetting & onboarding**
The moment you decide to trust a new carrier. Weak checks here let masks through.
- 3 Email & logins**
One hacked inbox or shared password turns a crook into a trusted insider.
- 4 Money handling**
Changing bank details or paying advances — the exact step BEC scams aim for.
- 5 New-carrier sign-up**
Fake or mailbox-only addresses let phantom and chameleon carriers be born.
- 6 Delivery & payment**
Fake PODs and double-broker tricks bite right at the end, when guards are down.

CHAPTER 5 • BY THE NUMBERS

This is real, and it is growing

A few numbers to keep you alert. Each one is from a named source so you can trust it.

\$725M

Estimated cargo-theft losses in 2025 — up 60% from 2024.

Verisk CargoNet

2,646

Confirmed cargo thefts in 2025 — up 18% from 2,243 the year before.

Verisk CargoNet

\$273,990

Average value of a single theft in 2025 — up 36%.

Verisk CargoNet

\$2.8B

Lost to business-email-compromise scams in one year (≈\$8.5B over three).

FBI IC3

~1/3

Share of cargo theft now done by "deception" — up from under 5% a few years ago.

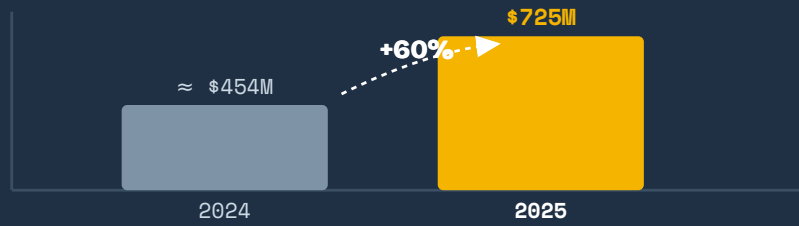
Industry trackers

~400%

Reported rise in double-brokering complaints across the industry.

Industry reporting

Estimated cargo-theft losses



► Estimated cargo-theft losses rose about 60% in one year — roughly \$454M in 2024 to about \$725M in 2025 (Verisk CargoNet).

An honest note about numbers. Nobody has a perfect, government-stamped count of every fraud in the chain. The U.S. regulator (FMCSA) even told Congress it **lacks the data** to fully measure double brokering. The strongest figures come from private trackers (like Verisk CargoNet) and the FBI. So treat these as the best estimates we have — directionally true and clearly rising — not exact totals.

CHAPTER 6 • YOUR DAILY SHIELD

The fixes, all in one place

If a handbook could be one habit, it's this one: **Stop • Check • Go**. Use it on every load, payment, and odd request.

STOP

When something is urgent, secret, or "too good," pause. Speed is the scammer's best friend — slow down on purpose.

CHECK

Verify on a channel *you* chose: a phone number you looked up, official records, a second person. Never the contact in the suspicious message.

GO

Only after it checks out, release the load or the money. Then write down what you did, in case you need a trail.

The desk checklist

Tick these for every new carrier, every payment change, every pickup.



Call back on a number you found yourself. Use official records — never the number written in the email or load post.



Check the carrier's authority and history. Be extra careful with brand-new authority, sudden contact/insurance changes, or a "carrier for sale."



Reject mailbox-only addresses. A real, verifiable place of business matters; virtual or PO-box "offices" are a warning sign.



Read the email address letter by letter. Watch for look-alikes (.co vs .com) and free email pretending to be a company.



Two people for any money or bank change. Confirm new bank details by voice on a known number before paying a cent.



Never click links or download "forms" from surprise emails. Type the website yourself or use a saved bookmark.



Photograph the pickup. Driver, licence, truck and trailer numbers, plate, and the paperwork — and check they match your booking.



Forbid re-brokering in writing, and confirm the delivering driver is the carrier you actually hired.



Confirm delivery with the receiver before you release the final payment. Don't pay on a POD alone.



Lock your logins. Turn on two-step (MFA), use unique passwords, your own account only, and remove access when people leave.



Treat a familiar voice with care. Voices can be faked — confirm big asks with a code word or a second channel.



When in doubt, escalate. It is always okay to say "let me confirm and call you back." A real partner will wait.

Red-flag cheat sheet — pause if you see these

- | | |
|-------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| 🚩 "Urgent — do it right now." | 🚩 "Keep this between us." |
| 🚩 Brand-new bank details by email. | 🚩 Rate or price that's too good. |
| 🚩 Brand-new authority, no history. | 🚩 Office is just a mailbox. |
| 🚩 Email address one letter off. | 🚩 Free email for a "company." |
| 🚩 Pushes you to skip your checks. | 🚩 Driver/truck doesn't match booking. |
| 🚩 Strange links or "dispute" forms. | 🚩 Phone number that keeps changing. |

In a 2026 public warning, the FBI described crooks getting into broker and carrier systems, changing a real carrier's official contact and insurance info, and posting **tens of thousands** of fake loads to trap honest truckers and steal freight. Their advice matches this whole chapter: **verify pickups a second way, don't trust a familiar name or email alone, use two-step checks, and document everything.**

If the FBI's own fix is "verify on a second channel," that's your fix too. — FBI IC3, 2026

CHAPTER 7 · CHECK IT YOURSELF

Verify before you trust

The single habit that stops most scams: look the company up **yourself**, on a website you typed — never a link they sent you. Here is exactly how, and where.

The 6-step carrier & broker check

- 1 Get their **legal company name** and their **USDOT or MC number**.
- 2 Look that number up **yourself** on FMCSA SAFER — type safer.fmcsa.dot.gov into your browser. Don't use a link they sent.
- 3 Confirm the **operating authority is ACTIVE** and the **insurance is on file** (FMCSA L&I — li-public.fmcsa.dot.gov).
- 4 Check the **phone and email** against the official record. If the number they gave you doesn't match, call the number **SAFER lists** instead.
- 5 Treat **recently-changed contact info** — or **no phone shown in SAFER** — as a red flag, and don't book until you confirm another way.
- 6 Only then book the load — and **photograph the driver, licence, truck, plate, and paperwork** at pickup.

FMCSA's own warning: even insurance certificates can be faked, and the top results in a web search can be fake profiles set up by scammers. Confirm names and numbers on **more than one** trusted source.

Where to check & where to report

✓ Check a carrier or broker — free & official

FMCSA SAFER — look up any carrier or broker by USDOT/MC number and see if their authority is active. → safer.fmcsa.dot.gov

FMCSA Licensing & Insurance (L&I) — confirm operating authority and that insurance is on file. → li-public.fmcsa.dot.gov

Report fraud — free & official

FBI IC3 — report online and cyber-enabled fraud, BEC, and stolen identity. → ic3.gov

FMCSA NCCDB — report bad brokers and carriers and freight fraud (it now has a freight-broker category). → nccdb.fmcsa.dot.gov

FTC — report scams and identity theft. → reportfraud.ftc.gov

USDOT Inspector General Hotline — fraud involving DOT programs. → oig.dot.gov/hotline
· phone **1-800-424-9071**

Helpful lines: FMCSA Contact Center **1-800-832-5660** · NCCDB hotline **1-888-368-7238**

Going further: does the truck actually exist?

The free tools above check a carrier's *paperwork* — their authority, insurance, and record. But a crook can have clean paperwork and still own **no trucks at all**. A newer kind of tool checks the carrier in the **real world**.

GenLogs is one example. It runs a nationwide network of roadside cameras and sensors that read the **USDOT number, plate, and logo** on passing trucks — about **15 million truck sightings a day** — and uses AI to match a carrier's real movements against what they claim on paper. (Its cameras ignore private cars and blur windows, so they only read commercial-truck markings.)

For a back-office desk, that kind of **physical verification** helps you:

- ✓ **Catch a "carrier" that exists only on paper** — one with no trucks actually on the road, which is the tell-tale sign of double brokering.
- ✓ **Confirm a carrier is real and active**, running the right equipment, before you hand over a load.
- ✓ **Find a stolen or missing trailer** — GenLogs offers a free service where carriers, brokers, or shippers submit a missing asset and get its last-known location and live alerts.
- ✓ **Expose "chameleon" carriers** — in the Indiana case in Chapter 8, an investigator used GenLogs to show AJ Partners was still hauling freight after its fatal crash.

Worth knowing: GenLogs is a paid commercial service (not a free government tool like SAFER), and it covers U.S. roads. Use it as an **extra layer** on top of the free checks — not a replacement. → genlogs.io

If you think you've been scammed — do this now

- 1 **Stop the payment.** Call your bank straight away and try to halt any pending transfer.
- 2 **Save everything.** Emails, phone numbers, documents, screenshots, and the load and booking details.
- 3 **Report it.** FBI IC3 (ic3.gov), FMCSA NCCDB (nccdb.fmcsa.dot.gov), and the FTC (reportfraud.ftc.gov).
- 4 **If your company's identity was used,** correct your contact details in SAFER and tell your insurer, your load boards, and your factoring company.
- 5 **Warn people.** Tell the real company being impersonated, and alert your own team so no one else falls for it.

CHAPTER 8 · REAL CASES, ON THE RECORD

This is really happening

Every scam in this book is real. Here are four cases you can look up yourself — with names, dates, and dollars, and a link to the official source or news report for each.

CASE FILE · carrier-impersonation ring (New York)

CHARGED · 2026

In June 2026, the Manhattan District Attorney charged eight people who ran a cargo-theft ring across the Northeast. Working with hacking groups that **phished shipment details**, they **impersonated real trucking companies**, won the loads with the stolen information, then arrived in trucks marked with the real carrier's name and drove the freight away. Across six thefts (October 2025–April 2026) they took goods worth about **\$4.49 million** — lamb, beef, roughly 25,000 pounds of cheese, copper, and cigarettes — and sold them on the black market. In one pickup a driver posing as **Viking Transport** collected 43,100 pounds of copper rod from a Newark warehouse. The cargo owners and the real carriers whose names were used had no idea until the goods were gone; cargo-theft analytics firm **Verisk CargoNet** assisted the investigation.

~\$4.49M stolen · 8 people charged · case IND-71638-26 — Manhattan D.A.

Sources: Manhattan D.A. — manhattanda.org · FreightWaves — freightwaves.com · Gothamist — gothamist.com

In January 2024, a finance worker at the Hong Kong office of **Arup** — the global engineering firm behind the Sydney Opera House — received an email from the "CFO" asking for a secret transfer. He was suspicious, so he joined a **video call** to check. On the call he saw and heard the CFO and several colleagues — but every one of them was an **AI deepfake**. Convinced, he made **15 transfers totaling about \$25.6 million** (HK\$200 million). He only realised it was fake after calling head office, and the money was never recovered. The lesson the whole industry took from it: **a familiar face and voice are no longer proof**.

~\$25.6M lost · 15 transfers · deepfake CFO + colleagues —
Hong Kong Police / Arup

Sources: CNN Business — [cnn.com](https://www.cnn.com) · Fortune — [fortune.com](https://www.fortune.com) · World Economic Forum — [weforum.org](https://www.weforum.org)

In February 2026, a truck crash in **Jay County, Indiana** killed four people. Investigators found the carrier, **AJ Partners**, was part of a **"chameleon" network** — companies that pile up violations, get shut down, then reopen the next day under a new name and a fresh DOT number to wipe the slate clean. The FMCSA put AJ Partners and four affiliated carriers (**KG Line Group, Tutash Express, RPM Hauling, and Valcins Trucking**) out of service; the driver had been "trained" by a **sham CDL school**. Government auditors (the U.S. GAO) have found these reincarnated carriers are about **three times more likely** to be in serious crashes. That is why a brand-new authority with no track record deserves a second look.

4 killed · 5 carriers put out of service · ~3× crash risk —
FMCSA / U.S. GAO

Sources: Overdrive — [overdriveonline.com](https://www.overdriveonline.com) · FreightWaves — [freightwaves.com](https://www.freightwaves.com) · U.S. Government Accountability Office (chameleon-carrier study)

Double brokering isn't new. In 2018 the U.S. **Federal Trade Commission** took action against a California freight broker, **Apex Freight Services**, that took payment from shippers but never delivered the loads or paid the carriers who hauled them. The broker **settled for \$500,000**. It's the same trick that fills complaint lines today: reported double-brokering complaints jumped about **400%** between late 2022 and early 2023.

\$500,000 settlement · ~400% rise in complaints (2022–2023) —
FTC / industry reporting

Sources: Grant Thornton (case summary) — [grantthornton.com](https://www.grantthornton.com) · U.S. FTC — [ftc.gov](https://www.ftc.gov)

Scammers win when we rush and are afraid to ask.

You win when you slow down and check. You don't need to be
a detective — you just need the habit. **When in doubt,
pause and verify.**

WHERE THESE FACTS COME FROM

Verisk CargoNet — 2024 & 2025 cargo-theft analyses (loss totals, incident counts, average theft value, and the shift toward high-value "deception" theft).

FBI / Internet Crime Complaint Center (IC3) — business-email-compromise loss figures and complaint counts; 2026 public service announcement on cyber-enabled strategic cargo theft. ic3.gov

FMCSA — Broker & Carrier Fraud and Identity Theft guidance, plus the National Consumer Complaint Database and the SAFER / L&I lookup tools. fmcsa.dot.gov

U.S. Government Accountability Office (GAO) — study finding "chameleon" (reincarnated) carriers are roughly three times more likely to be in serious crashes.

Industry reporting (Truckstop, TIA, and trade press) — the roughly 400% rise in double-brokering complaints (Q4 2022–Q1 2023) and broader fraud trends.

GenLogs — freight "Truck Intelligence" platform (roadside-sensor network + AI for physical carrier verification, fraud and cargo-theft prevention, and asset recovery). genlogs.io · reporting: cojdigital.com

CASES CITED IN CHAPTER 8

Carrier-impersonation ring, New York (2026) — Manhattan D.A.'s Office announcement (case IND-71638-26) and reporting. manhattanda.org · freightwaves.com

Arup deepfake video-call fraud (2024) — Hong Kong Police; Arup statements. cnn.com · weforum.org

"Chameleon" carrier network, Indiana (2026) — FMCSA / U.S. DOT out-of-service actions and reporting. overdriveonline.com

FTC v. Apex Freight Services (2018) — double-brokering enforcement; \$500,000 settlement. grantthornton.com

This handbook is general educational guidance for awareness and training — not legal, financial, or insurance advice. Court cases described here are based on public announcements and news reporting; charges are allegations and defendants are presumed innocent unless proven guilty. Verify carriers and partners through your company's official procedures, and report suspected fraud to the FBI (ic3.gov) and your fraud-prevention provider. Figures reflect the latest available reporting as of mid-2026 and may be updated by their sources.